

Tashiling Non Wood Forest Product Management Plan



**Semjong Geog
Tsirang Dzongkhag
Plan period: April 2020- March 2025**

NWFP management and marketing plan

Goal and objectives:

- ✓ To take socio-economic empowerment initiatives by women;
- ✓ To prevent Soil erosion and Land degradation through implementation of different SLM methods;
- ✓ To generate employment opportunities for women and youths in a group;
- ✓ To conserve the forest resources sustainably;
- ✓ To generate income for the group through Soft broom and fodder marketing;
- ✓ To support among the members during needy time;
- ✓ To explore market within Bhutan and to facilitate networking among groups to meet common purposes.

Description of NWFPs:

Among the resources optimally used for income generation from forest are Timber and Non Wood Forest Products (NWFPs). NWFPs play an important role in the daily lives and overall wellbeing of Bhutanese people especially in rural areas. Boom grass (NWFP) *Thysanolaena latifolia* has been emerged as one of the most widely cultivated cash crop in southern parts of Bhutan. People use stem and leaves as fodder for livestock and sale inflorescence as broom. Tsirang Dzongkhag has high potential to cultivate broom grass on a commercial scale and achieve self sufficiency; however, farmers have managed only on small scale, mostly at household level at the edge of their fields and by Farm road sides.

Likewise, TSD (Tashiling Sarekakthap Deytshenunder) has been managing 11 acres of broom grass since 2013 with 19 households. To enhance this particular group, UNDP has financially supported in 2018. Since then, the group members increased to 20 households and 15 acres of SRF land inside Tashiding CF is managed for 5 years period.

Table 1: Brief description of NWFPs for commercial harvesting

NWFP name	Harvesting area(s) (name)	Parts harvested	Use purpose (traditional & others)	Harvesting season (months)	Estimated quantity that can be collected¹
Broom Grass	Tashiling	Inflorescence	Soft Broom	December-May	20 head loads
Broom Grass	Tashiling	Leaves	Fodder	December-May	50 head loads

Table 2: Harvesting prescriptions for sustainable NWFP harvesting

Harvesting Rules	Things you will need
	-Hedge clipper -carrying materials Instructions ➤ Harvest broomcorn stalks in the fall, after the green stalks have turned brown; ➤ Cut down the stalks on a sunny day, preferably in the morning after the sun has burned off the dew. Cutting wet broomcorn is harder. Cut the stalks about 6 inches above the root with a safe tool such as a hedge cutter. The stalks are thick, and using a knife is more difficult and more dangerous; ➤ Lay the stalks out to dry, leaving about three inches between stalks. The stalks should be as much as possible for the entire day; ➤ Examine the stalks near the end of the drying day and look for the pest on the stalks. If you see pest damage such as significant chewing holes on stalk, throw it away. It is likely that pest is living in the stalk, which weakens it. Also throw away stalks showing damage such as severe bends and breaks. Stalks with black spots, which indicates mole, should also be discarded. These damaged stalks will not last through the drying process; ➤ Remove the stalks to a dry location such as a garage or barn before nightfall to protect them from moisture. Store them standing up. At this point, it is acceptable for the stalks to touch each other. They can be tied into bundles to save space; ➤ Dry the stalks for at least three more weeks. When they are completely dry they are very brittle. Do not store flammable materials near the stalk.

Tashiling Sarekakthap Deytshen Project Area Map

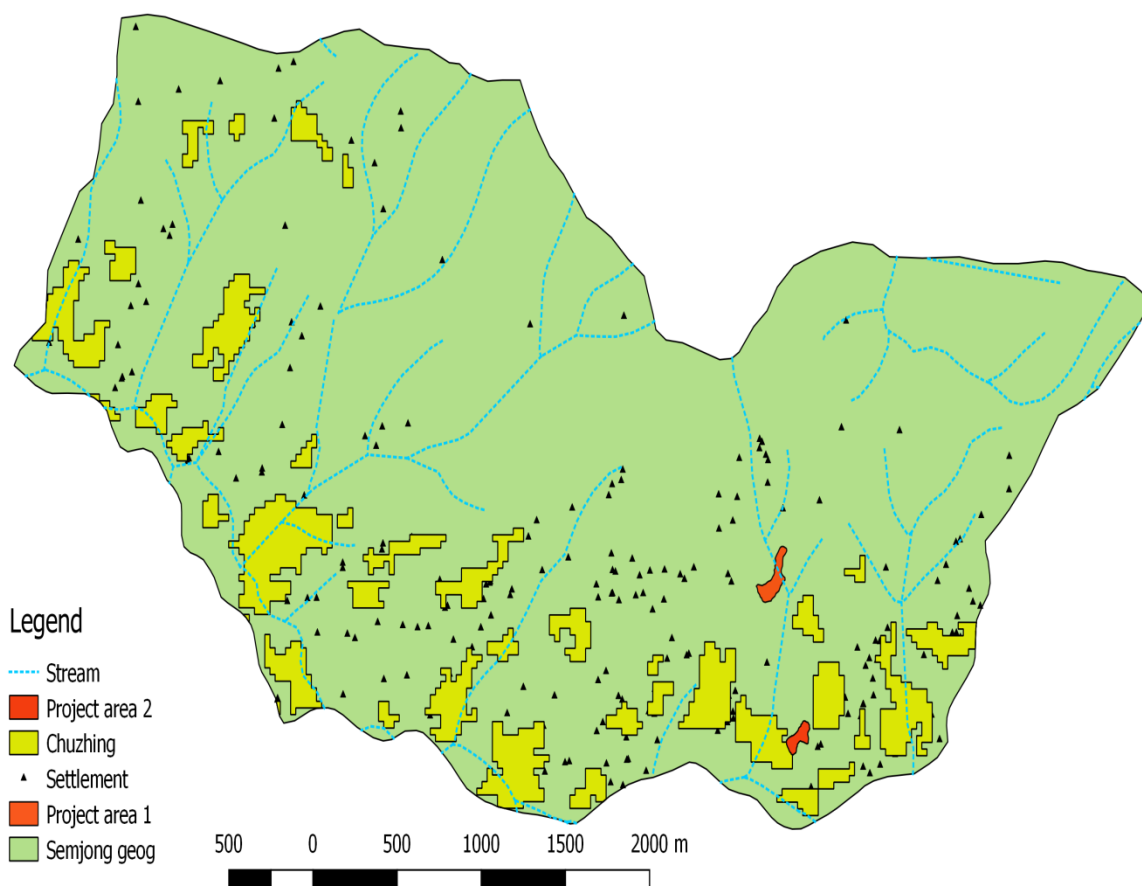


Table 3: Marketing and sales plan

<i>NWFP</i>	<i>Potential market</i>	<i>Estimated quantity for sale per season (unit)</i>	<i>Expected price per unit</i>	<i>Total (Nu)</i>
Inflorescences (Soft Broom)	Damphu Sunday Market & Gelephu	150 numbers	25/piece	3750.00
Fodder	Within members	50 head loads	100/head load	5000.00

Marketing arrangements:

Harvesting and marketing of products in a season will be done as a group and income generated will be deposited in the group account and divide equally among the members after 5 years. If the products could not be sold at the local markets, executive members will take products to the other Dzongkhags for marketing. Income generated will be divided equally; however, expenditures incurred during marketing by comitte management team on behalf of group will be born from group account before payment of income to the members.

Work plan:

Activities	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
Bush Clearing			✓	✓								
Weeding						✓	✓					
Refilling						✓	✓					
Harvesting	✓	✓	✓								✓	✓
Marketing			✓	✓	✓							

By-Laws: Group regulation and Norms

Members of the collection group	Village	Number of Households	Geog
	Tashiling Maed	20 HHs	Shemjong
	Responsibilities		
	-management of the NWFP -monitoring -attend meeting/work when required -control cattle from entrance inside NWFP area -permit to harvest and sale Broom as per the agreement and harvesting rules		

Coordinator	Mr. Purna Bdr. Bista
	Responsibilities of coordinator - Chair the meeting/decision making with members - Resolve disputes - Official correspondence - Arrangement for visitors - Inform members on the date and venue for carrying out the activities regarding NWFP management - Coordinate sale of NWFP product - Preparation of annual and final report

Secretary	Mrs. Indra Maya Saru
	- Officiate in absence of coordinator - Supervise activities - Minutes keeper - Record keeping - Assist treasure during fund transaction

Treasure	Mr. Deo Bdr. Mafchan
	- Fund transaction - Maintain cash transaction records - Collect membership fees and penalties - Financial arrangement

Membership fee and financial arrangements	- Members will pay the entry fee of Nu.200/year (within January) - Financial support for relevant activities will be met from penalties and entry fees. - Collected penalties and fees will be deposited in group account of BDBL
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Conflict Resolution	- Coordinator and Secretary will settle the case - Forward the case to the Geog Forestry Focal - Forward to Geog administration - Forward to CFO - Forward to District Court
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Penalties	➤ If the members do not attend meeting or group work, he/she will levy fine of Nu. 200/- per occasion ➤ Fine will be levied to those cattle owners who let lose cattle inside NWFP area as follows:	
	Members	Outsiders
	Fine of nu. 100/cattle with explanation letter If members do illegal work inside NWFP area he/she will replace the damage area and also pay fine equivalent to amount deposited by a member in a year.	Fine of nu. 200/cattle with written statement If outsider does illegal work inside NWFP area he/she will pay the fine of Nu. 2000/-plus 150/- per clump.

A. Membership arrangement

- Membership opportunity will be provided to all farmers of Semjong geog.
- The households who couldn't join the membership and attend during the initiation and in case of separation (chut-bhai), he/she can become a member after paying the amount of Nu. 4000/- and in addition equivalent to fee amount deposited by an individual till date.
- For the people who purchased the land at Tashiling and started to settle there and also if she/he is willing to join the group can be allowed as per section A (b).

B. Benefit sharing

- Broom: The product will be sold in the market and deposit cash income in the group account.
- Fodder: The fodder will be utilized equally among the members, however if they want to sell, they can auction to the customers.

C. Leaving NWFP group

- If the members do not abide by the by laws of NWFP group, he/she shall leave the group after paying the fine of Nu. 3000/- without any benefit.
- If the member has to leave the group with genuine reasons he/she will receive cash as share i.e. total saving fund in account divided by the existing number of members on the day of resignation.
- Re-entry of the members who had left the group with genuine reasons will be allowed to join the membership after repaying the amount that was taken from the group as share and he/she will be treated as new members. However, those who left without reason will be not allowed to join as member any more. The members who are leaving or joining the group will submit applications to the Coordinator.

D. Financial management

- Fund will be utilized for the purchase of tools and other activities related to NWFP management
- The group will not provide loan to members, if the total amount does not exceed nu. 20,000/- (twenty thousand) in the account and the reserve amount to be kept at bank will be nu. 3,000/- (three thousand)

- d) For the group member interest rate for the loan will be @ 1.25% per month for the duration of one year. However, loan will not be paid for the outsiders.
- e) The group will pay nu. 2,000/- (two thousand) only as condolence to the member, when there is demise of anyone within his/her family members.
- f) Any donation received will be deposited to the group account.

E. Record keeping

The following books and records will be kept by the group:

- a) Seedling and plantation record
- b) Cash book
- c) Money receipt
- d) Collection permit
- e) Record of fine & compensation
- f) Attendance register
- g) Meeting minutes
- h) Stock register
- i) Loan record
- j) Annual work plan and progress report

F. Incentives for management committee members

- a) Management committee members will serve for five years period after which new committees will be elected.
- b) If management committee members do not abide by the by law, they will be terminated from the members upon repaying amount equivalent to any damage/loss caused by them.
- c) Committee members will not have to contribute labour but they should supervise the work on turn wise basis.

Meeting

General meeting will be conducted twice in a year (June and December)

Miscellaneous

- If there is any geog development plan which is going to affect the area of NWFP, the concern authority will pay the compensation depending upon the damages cause to the NWFP.
- TSD will manage the NWFP inside Tashiding CF for the next five years and will pay 15% of the total income from selling their product to Tashiding CF for the development of this particular CF.

Membership list

Sl.no	Name	House no.	Tharm no	Chiwog
1	Mr. Deo Bdr. Mafchan	Ba-10-20	128	Tashiling Maed
2	Mr. Dil Bdr. Raika	9	28	-do-
3	Mr. Chandra Bdr. Alley	34	5	-do-
4	Mr. Gauri Man Mongar	88	22	-do-
5	Mr. Sha Bdr. Darlami	81	52	-do-
6	Mrs. Indra Maya Saru	39	33	-do-
7	Mr. Nandalal Khapangi	5	51	-do-
8	Mrs. Naina Maya Pulami	23	37	-do-
9	Mrs. Bhim Maya Fewali	30	56	-do-
10	Mrs. Krishna Maya Kararia	84	26	-do-
11	Mr. Tika Ram Jogi	68	27	-do-
12	Mrs. Dhan Maya Mongar	23 sep	37	-do-
13	Mr. Lal Bdr. Balampaki	22	46	-do-
14	Mr. Santa Bhir Saru	61	Nil	-do-
15	Mr. Purn Bdr. Bista	52	252	-do-
16	Mr. Chandanal Nepal	76	48	-do-
17	Mr. Lok Bdr. Balampaki	122	140	-do-
18	Mrs. Hema Devi Bista	70	533	-do-
19	Mr. Deo Bdr. Monger	30	37	-do-
20	Mr. Damber Singh Kepchaki	16	Nil	-do-